

The 5th Generation or the 32 bit era also saw more powerful 32 and 64 bit processors. And this meant more details and rise of fully 3D games. 3D became the standard with many game developers releasing their famous 2D titles as 3D. Now you could play FPS in a fully 3D environment. Focus shifted away from the old sidescrollers.

Major consoles

The console market was saturated at the time with more than 10 options and even Apple joining the bandwagon with its Apple Bandai Pippin (which miserably failed). But the race which was going to separate the leaders from the pack had already begun. The main competition was between the following 4 consoles –

- Atari Jaguar
- Sega Saturn
- Sony PlayStation
- Nintendo 64

Atari Jaguar

Atari had been long been a part of the video game industry. It had made quite a few successful products but the Atari Jaguar was going to be the last console it manufactured. 1989, Atari tasked Flare technology, a UK based company, to develop 2 consoles for it. The first one – the Atari Panther was supposed to compete with existing consoles on the market like the Sega Genesis and Super NES. While that was to happen, the company was to simultaneously work on Atari Jaguar, a futuristic console that was supposed to be better than any console on the market at the time. The quick progress being made on the Jaguar made Atari cancel Panther and instead directly go ahead with launching Jaguar.

The device was launched in late 1993, early 1994 across USA at a price lower than all of its competitors. But the device could never catch success and was plagued with a number of problems. Game development was difficult for the Atari console, thanks in part to the device's multi-chip architecture. The low sales of the console also didn't do anything to attract more developers to invest more time and resources in developing titles for it. There was no internal game development at Atari which could help and slowly it faded off. The launch of Sega Saturn and Sony PlayStation sealed the fate of both the console and the company. Jaguar was accepted as a failure and Atari moved on from the console market.